RESOLUTION NO. 2025-38

A RESOLUTION OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF CANYON LAKE, CALIFORNIA, OPPOSING THE PROPOSED CRESCENT GARDENS CEMETERY PROJECT LOCATED IN THE MEADOWBROOK AREA OF UNINCORPORATED RIVERSIDE COUNTY

WHEREAS, the Riverside County Planning Department is currently reviewing Conditional Use Permit No. 230002, a proposal to develop a cemetery in the Meadowbrook community of unincorporated Riverside County; and

WHEREAS, the proposed project site encompasses approximately 84.99 acres located north of Mauricio Street, east of Robert Street, south of River Road, and accessed from Garfield Road, including 21 parcels within the following Assessor's Parcel Numbers: 349-170-003 through 349-170-013; 349-170-035; 349-180-002 through 349-180-008; 349-180-016; 349-180-017; and 349-180-020; and

WHEREAS, the proposed development includes a 25-acre gravesite area with approximately 20,000 burial plots, an 8,983-square-foot mortuary, a 6,978-square-foot chapel, a 1,340-square-foot equipment shed, a 1,366-square-foot caretaker's residence, and 145 parking spaces; and

WHEREAS, the proposed cemetery site is located in close proximity to a regional drinking water reservoir; and

WHEREAS, the City Council is concerned that the placement of human remains and associated burial-related activities in this location poses a potential risk to water quality through the leaching of contaminants into groundwater and surface water supplies, which are critical for the health and well-being of surrounding communities; and

WHEREAS, similar projects have faced opposition and moratorium requests in other jurisdictions, including San Diego County, due to the potential for groundwater contamination and the need to protect sole-source or sensitive aquifers; and

WHEREAS, the City Council of the City of Canyon Lake finds it essential to prioritize long-term protection of local drinking water sources and maintain regional environmental safeguards.

NOW THEREFORE, THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF CANYON LAKE DOES HEREBY RESOLVE AS FOLLOWS:

Section 1. The above recitals are true and correct and are incorporated herein by reference.

Section 2. The City Council hereby formally opposes Conditional Use Permit No. 230002 and the proposed cemetery project in the Meadowbrook area of Riverside County due to its location near a drinking water reservoir and the potential environmental risks it poses to regional groundwater and surface water resources.

Section 3. The City Council urges the Riverside County Board of Supervisors, Planning Commission, and other relevant reviewing agencies to deny approval of the project or require the preparation of a comprehensive environmental impact report (EIR) to fully assess water quality impacts, alternative sites, and mitigation measures.

Section 4. The City Clerk shall transmit a copy of this Resolution to the Riverside County Planning Department.

Section 5. The provisions of this Resolution are severable and if any provision, clause, sentence, word or part thereof is held illegal, invalid, unconstitutional, or inapplicable to any person or circumstances, such illegality, invalidity, unconstitutionality, or inapplicability shall not affect or impair any of the remaining provisions, clauses, sentences, sections, words or parts thereof of the Resolution or their applicability to other persons or circumstances.

Section 6. That the City Clerk shall certify to the adoption of this Resolution and that the same shall be in full force and effect.

Section 7. This Resolution shall take effect immediately upon its adoption.

PASSED, APPROVED AND ADOPTED this 13th day of August 2025.

Mark Terry, Mayor

ATTEST:

Sheryl L. Garcia, MMC, CPM
City Clerk

STATE OF CALIFORNIA)
COUNTY OF RIVERSIDE) SS
CITY OF CANYON LAKE)

I, Sheryl L. Garcia, City Clerk of the City of Canyon Lake, California, do hereby certify, that the foregoing is a true and correct copy of Resolution No. 2025-38, adopted by the City Council at a meeting held on August 13, 2025, by the following vote:

AYES:	Castillo, Smith, Steeber, Welty, Terry
NOES:	None
ABSTAIN:	None
ABSENT:	None

Sheryl L. Garcia, MMC, CPM
City Clerk